

MOVIE

Bleach

★★★★☆ | We've seen a series of live-action adaptations of popular anime gone wrong recently. Fullmetal Alchemist and Death Note are veritable titans in the anime world in terms of fan following, however, their live-action remakes were riddled with issues and were a disappointment to legions of faithful fans. So, when a live-action adaptation of the popular shonen title Bleach was announced, you know that a lot of fans weren't exactly overjoyed. As it turns out, however, the movie isn't even half as bad as you would expect according to the recent trend. In fact, it wouldn't be wrong to say that this is perhaps the best live action adaptation of an anime we've seen in recent times after Ghost in the Shell. The casting is perfect and the entire cast emulates the mannerisms of the characters from the anime adaptation – right from an angry, feisty Ichigo to a regal, cold Byakuya and everyone in between. The story for the live action movie is restricted mostly to the first arc of the anime, with some elements from later arcs introduced as well. This decision turns out to be in the movie's favour, as the first arc is mostly set in urban landscapes with the occasional hollow showing up, removing the need for excessive expenditure on special effects – a point that has become sore after half-hearted attempts by previous anime live action adaptations. However, don't let this make you feel that the movie lacks finesse. In fact, some situational depictions could even be better than the anime itself, especially one involving a flashback with Ichigo's dead mother. Overall, go ahead and watch this one, especially if you've seen the Bleach anime and loved it.



COMIC BOOK

Rakshak Issue #1

★★★★☆ | Rakshak tells the tale of how a personal tragedy transforms an ex-army, disabled individual into a vigilante for justice. Quite a few similar celebrated characters in the superhero mythos like Batman, Arrow and even beyond the realm of superheroes have been created by artists and loved by readers over the years. The weaknesses of the hero are exploited in situations to put him at a disadvantage. However, in the very same scene, the hero's skills are also showcased through his analysis of the injuries on his own body as well as the ones he is inflicting onto attackers. The attention to detail is also good.

There are a couple of things that one could have an issue with. For starters, in the backstory establishing Aditya's military background, there's an undue amount of racism and implied hate-mongering by a particular character – one who is repeatedly admonished by the protagonist and one who outright defies his chain of command. Also, the use of a sensitive issue as the personal tragedy can be perceived as bordering on exploitation by readers. However, a number of superhero and vigilantism stories are based on similar real-world issues.



UP AND COMING

COMIC BOOK

Spider-Geddon



The sequel to Spider-Verse, where the entire Spider-family came together, will feature the introduction of

Spider-man from the popular PS4 video game multiverse into the Marvel Universe.

Release date: September 26, 2018.

TV SHOW

The Gifted Season 2



Mutants are divided into two factions and the violent side is beginning to gain more power. Season 2 will go through a time jump from where it had left the story in the first season.

Release date: September 25, 2018.

MOVIE

Venom



Tom Hardy stars as reporter Eddie Brock aka Venom who gains superhero abilities from an alien symbiote in a universe without Spider-man.

Release date: October 5, 2018.